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To the Hiring Manager,

My name is Maya Winland-Gaetz, and I am a second-year Electrical Engineering student and Canadian citizen seeking my first co-op term in as the Electrical Engineering Co-op Student at Ocean Networks Canada, available for 4 months. As a mature student who previously studied at the graduate level in aquatic geochemistry, I returned to university to pursue my passion for electronic design, and I believe my qualifications both old and new would make me an ideal fit for this role.

Although my academic performance is very strong, my study of electronics is a central feature of my life. I joined the UVic Satellite Design Club as a highly active member, and have assumed responsibility for the radio-communications systems. I designed two evaluation boards for the TI CC1201 transceiver SoC and a matched power amplifier, have just completed hand-assembling them using hot air rework and a soldering iron, and am currently engaged in developing a testing and verification plan. Besides these, I spend much of my free time on personal electronics projects, the most current among which is designing and programming a waveform generator to serve my long-term goal of constructing a hybrid analog-digital music synthesizer. I find it easy to self-motivate when the work is its own reward.

Over the course of my previous career in geoscience, I cultivated a highly precise and focused approach to my work, as well as a deep enjoyment from working with and maintaining sophisticated instruments. As trace metal analysis is extremely sensitive to contamination, I had to develop a rigorous and detail-oriented observance of procedure. I also spent an amount of time sailing in Hamilton Harbour, taking sediment samples and limnological profiles using YSI multiprobes for classroom activities I was helping to organize.

I would be thrilled to have the opportunity to interview with you, and yet more thrilled still to be able to work at Ocean Networks Canada! Although I left my previous career in environmental science, I still strongly believe in the values that led me to seek it in the first place: using sustainable technology and industry to leave the world a better place than we found it. I believe there is much I can bring to the table, be it from my previous career or my current drive to learn and achieve more in the field of electrical engineering.

If you are interested, I can be best reached over email, but I am also available via phone if that would work better for you. Thank you for taking the time to read my letter, and for your consideration.

I look forward to hearing from you!
Sincerely,

Maya Winland-Gaetz